Recover mysql corrupted database

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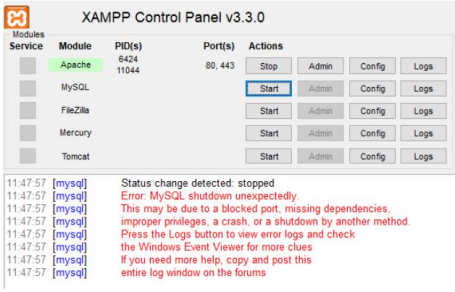
Scenario :

I have implemented a daily task list using mysql and php so I use xamp server for this and today morning I restart my system without closing my service and any application which is running on my desktop and wait the system restarted successfully but when I try to restart my xampp server in this I saw my apache are started successfully but my mysql are not started.



❌ MySQL/MariaDB in XAMPP is crashing on startup

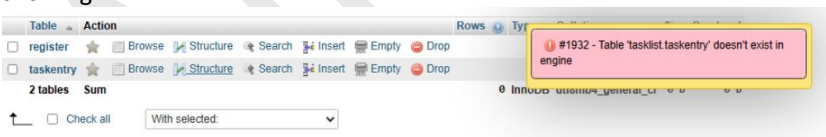
Means mysql shutdown unexpectedly

Cause	Happens when
Port conflict	Another mysql is running
Data corruption	ibdata1 / ib_logfile damged
Wrong config	my.ini problem
Windows service clash	Old mysql service exists

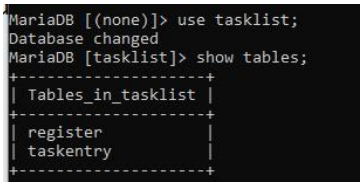
First I have check my mysql_error.log file in the errorlog doesn't any issue found .
Also check the port in cmd is alredy running still this also not an issue .

```
netstat -ano | findstr :3306
```

Then I check my data folder and also login to check my database to check table the error is bleow showing .



In this the table are showing but when I try to access then it is showing the above error .
So this is s ghost table exist in file system / meta data but not in innodb directory.



```
MariaDB [(none)]> use tasklist;
Database changed
MariaDB [tasklist]> show tables;
+--------------------+
| Tables_in_tasklist |
+--------------------+
| register           |
| taskentry          |
+--------------------+
```

Note : Now this is a **database-level issue**, not a server issue.
#1932 – Table tasklist.taskentry doesn't exist in engine

```
MariaDB [tasklist]> desc taskentry;
ERROR 1932 (42S02): Table 'tasklist.taskentry' doesn't exist in engine
MariaDB [tasklist]> ALTER TABLE taskentry DISCARD TABLESPACE;
ERROR 1932 (42S02): Table 'tasklist.taskentry' doesn't exist in engine
```

Meaning : is the table are showing in the database but the actual data files are missing or corrupted. Means database know the table name but can not find it's storage .

Note : In this case first we have take a copy of data directory : c:/xampp/mysql/data take a copy of that data directory for recovery old data purpose .

Or if u have .sql latest backup then restore it .

If backup file are not available then try below steps for recovery purpose .

First I **completely remove it and recreate it cleanly**, then reattach data.

Step by step to correct fix :
We will clean the meta data first .

STEP 1: Remove Broken Table Forcefully

SET FOREIGN_KEY_CHECKS=0;

DROP TABLE IF EXISTS taskentry;

SET FOREIGN_KEY_CHECKS=1;

STEP 2: Check It's Gone

SHOW TABLES;

STEP 3: Stop MySQL

Close XAMPP → Stop MySQL.

STEP 4: Delete Leftover Files Manually
C:\xampp\mysql\data\tasklist\

delete if present .

taskentry.ibd
taskentry.frm
taskentry.cfg (if exists)

STEP 5: Start MySQL Again

STEP 6: Recreate Table (Exact Structure)

```
MariaDB [tasklist]> CREATE TABLE `taskentry` (
    ->   `id` int(11) NOT NULL AUTO_INCREMENT,
    ->   `task_name` varchar(100) NOT NULL,
    ->   `discription` text NOT NULL,
    ->   `status` varchar(30) NOT NULL,
    ->   `date` timestamp NOT NULL DEFAULT current_timestamp(),
    ->   `update_date` timestamp NULL DEFAULT NULL,
    ->   PRIMARY KEY (`id`)
    -> ) ENGINE=InnoDB AUTO_INCREMENT=552 DEFAULT CHARSET=utf8mb4 COLLATE=utf8mb4_general_ci;
```

STEP 7: Discard Tablespace
ALTER TABLE taskentry DISCARD TABLESPACE;

```
MariaDB [tasklist]> ALTER TABLE taskentry DISCARD TABLESPACE;
Query OK, 0 rows affected (0.080 sec)
```

STEP 8: Copy Old .ibd

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C:\xampp\mysql\data_old\tasklist\

copy taskentry.ibd

paste into

C:\xampp\mysql\data\tasklist\

STEP 9: Import Tablespace
ALTER TABLE taskentry IMPORT TABLESPACE;

```
MariaDB [tasklist]> ALTER TABLE taskentry IMPORT TABLESPACE;
Query OK, 0 rows affected, 1 warning (0.436 sec)
```

STEP 10: Test
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM taskentry;

```
MariaDB [tasklist]> select count(*) from taskentry;
+----------+
| count(*) |
+----------+
|     1195 |
+----------+
1 row in set (0.003 sec)
```

If DISCARD TABLESPACE fails → table definition is corrupt.

Then only option:

Restore from .sql backup
Or rebuild manually

When Does This Method Actually Work?

Only if we have a .ibd file and .cfg file available
taskentry.ibd
taskentry.cfg

From same server / version
Then
CREATE TABLE taskentry (...);
ALTER TABLE taskentry DISCARD TABLESPACE;
-- copy ibd + cfg
ALTER TABLE taskentry IMPORT TABLESPACE;

Then Data returns.

But this is **advanced recovery**, not normal restore.

Best practice is that if we have recent backup then we restore .

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